

United States at that time refused to recognize. He wanted me to visit his country, study its affairs, then write a series of articles recommending recognition.

I knew, however, I would not be able to write with enthusiasm and so with conviction. The reason was simple; I did not believe in the cause. I valued my integrity more than I valued the money I would have earned by dipping my pen into muddy ink.

Read this carefully: *If you compromise with your own conscience, you will weaken your conscience. Soon your conscience will fail to guide you and you never will have real wealth based on peace of mind.*

When I speak this way I give you full credit for being an adult, an intelligent person who uses his intelligence. You can see that such precepts, or the same precepts expressed better by Emerson or other great thinkers, are not merely "bright sayings." They are vital laws of life. They work.

Let me add one more precept to this very important matter of conveying ideas from your mind to another's:

You cannot afford to suggest to another person, by word of mouth or in writing, or through any act, that which you yourself do not believe.

Surely that is sufficiently straight-from-the-shoulder.

Where is your enthusiasm focused? When you train salesmen, you meet hundreds of men who may be described loosely as *salesman types*. They are first of all remarkable for their enthusiasm. Everything they say has punch behind it. Every action, even the action of sitting down, appears to proceed from some source of inward persuasive energy.

I have seen some of these men succeed splendidly—and I have seen others fail, and fail, and give up.

As Emerson said: "I learn the wisdom of St. Bernard, 'Nothing can work me damage except myself; the harm that I sustain I carry about with me, and never am a real sufferer but by my own fault.'"

The trouble with those enthusiastic men who failed was that they were all enthusiasm and not much else. The damage they sustained to their careers came from their fault in not backing their enthusiasm with plain, honest knowledge—with a willingness to go the extra mile—with a sincere interest in someone besides themselves.

Over and over I have seen such men sell a product because they simply overwhelmed the customer with the driving